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Making the Cut

The trends that made a mark on the runway

ONCE OVER

The jumpsuit, like Anand Kabra's design, was a '70s favourite but it's back. Long or short, wear it you must.



ONE SHOULDER

Just like this flaming Mandira Wirk maxi, one shoulder dresses, both long and short were all over the place.



ORANGE OBSESSION

In dresses and saris, the colour was everywhere including Nachiket Barve maxis.



SEE IT THROUGH

Sheers, as in Neha Agarwal churidars, were seen often, but don't follow without caution.



SABBAH SHARMA, 26

The designer who studied fashion at the Istituto Marangoni, Milan, was very happy retailing out of three Mumbai stores. But the owner of multi-designer store Zoya pushed her and Sharma can't believe the overwhelming response. Her structured dresses with mosaic work look like carefully crafted objects.

newbies. The young designers, most just a couple of seasons old, played with fabrics, showed their craft with tucks and drapes, giving fashion watchers some much-needed fuel. "With every season they're growing. Raakesh Agarwal, who's barely been around, got a solo show this time and so did Anand Kabra," says Alka Nishar, owner of multi-designer store Aza.

The second day of the week particularly belonged to the next generation. The GenNext show, where

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KIRAN AND MEGHNA, 29 & 26

Kiran Jaisinghani and Meghna Agarwal are very clear about one thing. They want to always create wearable clothes that highlight a woman's femininity. But that doesn't mean they take the easy way out. Elaborate pleats, tucks and folds that look effortless are their trademark.

rookie designers are given a platform to show their creations, was held on this day and was one of the strongest of all times. Amalraj Sengupta stuck to whites and greys with dashes of lemon but showed that he had mastered overlapping in dresses. Sabbah Sharma was so overwhelmed by the orders that she's now deciding who to pick. Masaba, who had block printed the collection personally, played with handlooms.

While the first timers may have been a bit rough around the edges, their predecessors seemed to have cleaned up good. Aneeth Arora, who worked with the gamcha from Assam to craft dresses and Arjun Saluja with his gothic influences, both left hard to please fashion critics satisfied. Anuj Sharma, back after a season break, wanted people to think and not just dress. His collection, Button Masala had a single piece of cloth with buttons sewn at a 2 cm distance. Sharma says, "The dress can be worn as the wearer buttons. Use it as a bag even." Paromita Banerjee, barely one season old, bagged orders by the truckload. Kiran and Meghna of Myoho were admired by Bombay Electric's Priya Kishore. And Kallol Datta, the kohl-eyed boy from Kolkata, found endorsement from none other than IMG senior Vice President Fern Mallis, who wore his creation.

Already there's a strong undercurrent that instead of fighting over an established name for the finale designer like this time, Lakme should give the new talent a chance. Not afraid of taking risks, it might not be long before these young designers actually become a cut above.